

Brother MFC-5460CN

The Affordable Network MFD

Print, scan, fax, copy and get photo prints all at a great price—seem impossible? Well, the Brother MFC-5460CN seems to be what you are looking for—at least at first look. Like all Brother MFDs, this one sports a no-nonsense, office look, with rugged build. It is quite small. At the front is a two-line, backlit LCD indicator that reports a lot of data and also lets you access the control panel menu. The input paper tray can accommodate 100 pages—just enough for a small to medium office—and the 35-page ADF tray is foldable.

The printer sports a resolution of 6000 x 1200 dpi—fairly high. There are four colour cartridges, and access to these is made easy by means of a door at the front of the unit. The flatbed scanner can scan legal-size documents. The printer supports most popular memory formats and it even

has PictBridge.

Connectivity is via USB and a network interface, but you will need to weave the wires through the provided channel into the heart of the device. The advantage: no accidental disconnections; disadvantage: it's irritating, and wires may not last long due to all the twisting.

The inbuilt 33.6 kbps fax can store up to 400 pages and is capable of broadcasting to up to 150 locations. The phonebook memory is 100 numbers.

Printing is slow; the printer took half a minute to print a simple text document in normal mode, and it took over a minute to print the same in best mode. Print quality is decent and sharp. There is some amount of graininess in photo prints, but it's good enough for the average home user. The copier does an excellent job.

The software bundle



consists of the MFL-Pro Suite (a control centre of sorts), PaperPort SE with OCR (a definite plus), and even Presto! PageManager OCR for Mac users.

At its price, we can say this is a good buy, if you don't mind waiting a bit for the print.

Specifications

Printer resolution: 6000 x 1200

dpi; Printing technology: thermal inkjet; Number of cartridges: 4; Scanner resolution (optical): 2400 x 1200 dpi; Input paper tray capacity: 100 sheets; ADF capacity: 35 sheets; Memory slots: CF, MS, MS Pro, SD, MMC, xD Picture Card; I/O ports: USB, RJ-45; Fax memory: 400 pages; Auto-dial: 100; Broadcast locations: 150; Weight: 9 kg; Dimensions: 44 (W) x 39.5 (D) x 22.6 (H) cm

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Web site: www.brother.in
Price: Rs 13,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

ViewSonic PJ258D

Ouch—smoking hot!

ViewSonic is just one of the many brands trying to push projectors into the home theatre market as good replacements for large TVs. The design of the PJ258D is great—it's compact and has a jet black glossy piano finish which makes it stand out—and which also makes it a fingerprint magnet.

Screen quality is pretty decent—quite sharp, and zooming only affects it a little. The display turns out very bright, and is very prominent even in a well lit room. Text is readable, but the best results are achieved during image and movie viewing—Thus making it good for multimedia purposes.

The remote control is small and moulded to fit the average hand well. The

buttons are soft and easy to use. IR ports have been positioned on the front as well as at the back, so you don't have to plan where you'll stand.

You can connect an iPod to the projector to watch your favourite movies on the big screen. The standard inputs are VGA, S-Video, Composite, and a standard analogue audio in. The USB port can be used to upgrade the firmware.

Heating, as with all projectors, still remains an issue. The fan spews out

hot air continuously from its side, but the ViewSonic PJ258D still gets awfully hot even after just 15 minutes of use. The stand for raising the projectors front is a little flimsy.

The manual is very basic and has information on the parts of the project and how it's supposed to be set up. A large pouch is supplied as well.

At a price of Rs 70,000, the ViewSonic PJ258D is reasonably priced and offers good performance. Also, it's cheaper than buying an LCD or Plasma TV with a comparable viewing area.

The iPod docking facility might attract a few users, but the heat it generates is definitely a concern if you plan on using it for many hours at a stretch.

Specifications

Size: 40-inch to 300-inch (diagonal), Pixel format: 1024 x 768, Dimensions: 11.3x7.5x3.5 inches, Lamp: 2000 hours (normal), Contrast ratio: 2000:1.

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Web site: <http://ap.viewsonic.com/in>
Price: Rs 70,000



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★